Crew Resource Management Cheatsheet

Effective communication

- If you think comms are breaking down, stop and fix that first.
- Appoint a PM, leader, or communications officer if needed.
- Message → read-back → acknowledgement.

Shared mental model

- Do we have the same idea of the goal and how we get there?
- Fully understand situation before beginning.
- Common terminology for communication.
- Write stuff down (succinctly) for reference.

Short-term strategy

- Everyone should know what comes next and their roles.
- Updated as time goes on, as much as needed.
- Briefings: Stop → Assess → Plan → (Questions) → Go/no-go.

Situational awareness

- Ensure coordination; announce significant actions.
- Announce any significant observations to others.
- Have "lookouts" when the environment is too complex.

Challenge and response

- When you see something off, speak up and expect a response.
- Attention → Concern → Root-problem → Proposal → Buy-in.

Error management

- Prepare reactions and react sooner rather than later.
- Something goes wrong: analyze system, no human blame.
- Facts → Timeline → Analysis → Recommendations.

Richard Darst / CC-0 / 2026-05-26

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Project meeting checklist

Reminders about meetings with customers.

Every meeting
- Follow "CRM Cheatsheet".
- Beginning: What is the purpose? Shared mental model.
- At end: Summary {non-technically & technically}

Contact meeting
- Purpose: Share info of what RSEs can do.
- Listen to problems, instant help, future ideas.

Kick-off meeting may include supervisor
- Purpose: Dig out *all* the relevant info first.
- Output: statements of need (non-technical)
- Output: statement of need (semi-technical).
- Template doc → first non-technical parts.
- Acknowledge the difficulties and risk.
- → Bring to RSE weekly to find planners.

Technical planning meeting
- Purpose: initial plan of implementation.
- Template doc → details
- Determine any new risks. Tell supervisor.
- → Bring to RSE weekly meeting for acceptance.

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